

RIB VAULT A type of vault that, like a groin vault, is formed by the intersection of two barrel vaults at right angles. The apexes of a rib vault are marked by stone ribs that divide the surface into curved triangular panels. This style of vaulting developed during the era of Gothic architecture. *See also* Gothic, groin vault, vault.

ROCOCO A highly decorative style of the mid-18th century that spread from France and Italy throughout central Europe. Characterized by an abundance of curves, moldings, and painted stucco, it was intended to inspire awe in the viewer. However, the embellishments were typically confined to the interiors of buildings and the exteriors were usually more restrained. *See also* stucco.

ROMANESQUE An architectural style of the early Middle Ages that combined elements of ancient Roman and Byzantine buildings. It is characterized by thick walls, round arches, the use of barrel vaulting, and a relative simplicity of plan and form. *See also* arch, barrel vault.

ROOD SCREEN An ornate partition of open tracery—made of wood, stone, or wrought iron—between the chancel and nave in a church. The screen is typically topped by a

cross or crucifix, which when hung above the entrance to a chancel is known as a rood. *See also* chancel, church, nave.

ROOF *See* panel, below.

ROSE WINDOW A large, circular, decorative window, often with stained glass. Rose windows are typically found in churches and cathedrals at the end of the nave, behind the altar and in the transepts. *See also* nave, transept.

ROTUNDA A building or a room with a circular floor plan covered by a dome.

ROUNDEL A round tower built as part of a set of defensive walls and meant to accommodate the placement of artillery.

RUSTICATION Finishing stone blocks with a rough surface. The blocks are cut back around the edges to give prominence to the rough area.

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SARCOPHAGUS A receptacle for a corpse that also serves as a monument and is often displayed

above ground. The sarcophagus can take the form of a stone box with carved decoration or, in the case of the ancient Egyptians, it can be shaped from wood and have a more humanoid shape.

SASH WINDOW A window with one or more vertical panels that are opened by sliding up or down.

SCREEN A thin, lightweight, free-standing wall that can be moved around to divide a room.

SEGMENTAL ARCH An arch in which the curve is less than a full 180 degrees. *See also* arch.

SEPULCHRE A burial vault or tomb.

SETBACK A steplike recession in a wall.

SEXPARTITE VAULT A rib vault divided into six bays. *See also* rib vault.

SHAFT The long, narrow, vertical cylinder that forms the body of a column.

SHELL VAULT A thin, self-supporting vault, typically made of reinforced concrete. *See also* reinforced concrete, vault.

SHINGLES Small, thin squares or rectangles of material—usually wood, asphalt, or slate—that are laid as overlapping courses for a roof covering or hung as a weather-proof covering on the sides of buildings. If they are made out of clay, and possibly shaped, they are called tiles.

SKYSCRAPER A habitable high-rise building of more than 40 or 50 stories. The Council on Tall Buildings and Urban Habitat defines a skyscraper as a building that reaches or exceeds 490 ft (150 m) in height.

SMART BUILDING A building that incorporates advanced technology such as intelligent management systems that monitor the energy consumption and carbon footprint of the building and gather other data in order to continually improve performance and user efficiency.

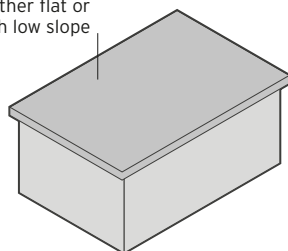
SOFFIT The underside of a construction element such as an arch or architrave, or the board covering the undersurface of the eaves on a roof.

ROOF

The roof is the covering of the top of a building, protecting it against the elements. The form of roofs varies greatly from region to region; for example, simple flat roofs are common in hot climates, while in parts of the world with

frequent rainfall, the preference is for gabled and hipped roofs that are pitched to shed water. Mansard roofs prove useful if the building needs to be expanded vertically, due to the almost vertical bottom slope.

single surface, either flat or with low slope

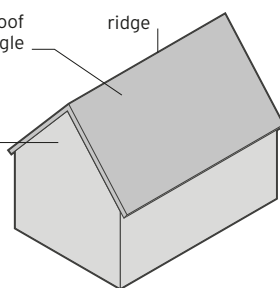


FLAT ROOF

two sides of roof pitched at an angle

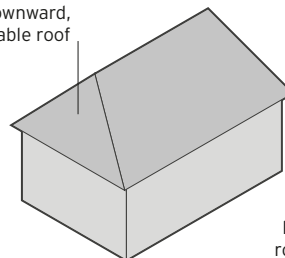
ridge

gable end is vertical



GABLE ROOF

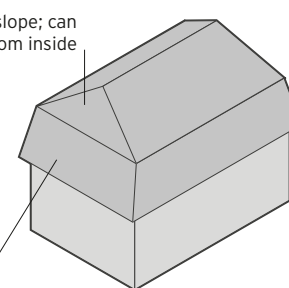
all sides of roof slope downward, unlike gable roof



HIPPED ROOF

less steep upper slope; can accommodate a room inside

lower section of roof slopes more steeply than upper section



MANSARD ROOF